NHMEC Wellness Herbalist Diploma

Module 10: Professional Practice, Ethics & Documentation

Professional Registration Diploma

Estimated Completion Time: 25–30 Hours

Module Overview

Professionalism is one of the defining characteristics of a Registered Wellness Herbalist. While herbal knowledge forms the foundation of practice, professionalism establishes credibility, trust, and accountability. Clients, families, churches, and communities place confidence in Wellness Herbalists who demonstrate ethical conduct, accurate documentation, appropriate communication, and respect for professional boundaries.

This module prepares students for professional registration by exploring the ethical responsibilities of the Wellness Herbalist, including educational scope of practice, informed consent, confidentiality, wellness documentation, recordkeeping, and continuing education.

Students will also learn how to organize professional wellness records, maintain appropriate documentation, and develop systems that support quality educational services.

Learning Objectives

Upon completion of this module, students will be able to:

- Explain the ethical responsibilities of a Registered Wellness Herbalist.
- Differentiate between wellness education and the practice of medicine.
- Develop professional wellness documentation systems.
- Maintain confidential wellness records.
- Apply informed consent principles.
- Demonstrate professional communication.
- Understand continuing education and registration responsibilities.
- Build a professional practice that reflects biblical integrity and accountability.

Required Reading

Primary Text

Review:

The Wellness Herbalist: A Guide to Family, Community, Kitchen, and Seasonal Wellness

- Chapters 1–8 (Review)

Companion Manual

Review:

- Wellness Documentation Forms
- Client Intake Forms
- Wellness Review Templates
- Follow-up Forms
- Educational Disclaimer Forms
- Code of Ethics
- Registration Requirements

Previous Coursework

Review materials from:

- Community Herbalist
- Family Herbalist
- Holistic Anatomy & Physiology
- Kitchen PENothecary™

Professional Identity

A Registered Wellness Herbalist serves as an educator.

Professional responsibilities include:

- Teaching wellness principles.
- Encouraging healthy lifestyle habits.
- Providing educational resources.
- Supporting informed decision-making.

- Maintaining professional integrity.

Professionalism is demonstrated through knowledge, humility, honesty, and consistent ethical conduct.

Scope of Practice

The Wellness Herbalist provides educational wellness support.

Professional activities may include:

- Wellness education
- Herbal education
- Nutrition education
- Lifestyle coaching
- Community presentations
- Wellness planning
- Kitchen herbal instruction
- Seasonal wellness education

The Wellness Herbalist does **not**:

- Diagnose disease.
- Prescribe medications.
- Perform medical procedures.
- Interpret laboratory tests as medical diagnoses.
- Recommend discontinuing prescribed treatments.
- Represent themselves as a licensed physician unless separately credentialed.

Maintaining clear professional boundaries protects both the practitioner and the public.

Ethical Principles

The NHMEC Code of Ethics is based upon:

Integrity

Always communicate honestly.

Respect

Honor the dignity and autonomy of every individual.

Confidentiality

Protect personal information entrusted to you.

Competence

Practice only within your education and training.

Accountability

Accept responsibility for your actions and decisions.

Stewardship

Honor God through faithful service, humility, and lifelong learning.

Informed Consent

Before providing educational wellness services, participants should understand:

- The purpose of the consultation or educational session.
- The educational nature of the service.
- The limits of the Wellness Herbalist's scope.
- Their responsibility to make informed decisions regarding their health.
- The importance of consulting licensed healthcare professionals when appropriate.

Written informed consent promotes transparency and mutual understanding.

Documentation

Professional documentation serves several important purposes:

- Supports continuity of care.
- Tracks educational progress.
- Documents wellness goals.
- Records follow-up recommendations.
- Protects both practitioner and participant.

Documentation should be:

- Accurate
- Legible
- Organized
- Objective
- Respectful
- Secure

Wellness Records

A professional client file may include:

- Intake questionnaire
- Wellness history
- Educational goals
- Observation notes
- Wellness plan
- Nutrition recommendations
- Herbal education provided
- Follow-up summaries
- Signed consent forms
- Educational resources distributed

Documentation should focus on observations and education rather than medical diagnosis.

Confidentiality

Personal information shared during educational consultations should remain confidential except when disclosure is required by law or authorized by the individual.

Students should develop secure systems for storing both paper and electronic records.

Professional Communication

Registered Wellness Herbalists communicate with professionalism in every setting.

This includes:

- Email correspondence
- Telephone conversations

- Social media
- Public presentations
- Printed materials
- Client interactions

Communication should be respectful, accurate, and free from misleading health claims.

Continuing Education

Professional registration requires ongoing learning.

Continuing education may include:

- Workshops
- Conferences
- Research review
- Professional reading
- Advanced certifications
- Teaching experiences
- Community service

Lifelong learning helps ensure that educational materials remain current and evidence-informed.

Professional Boundaries

Maintaining healthy boundaries supports ethical practice.

Examples include:

- Respecting confidentiality.
- Avoiding conflicts of interest.
- Recognizing the limits of one's expertise.
- Referring individuals to appropriate professionals when needed.
- Maintaining objective educational relationships.

Applying the Holistic P.E.N. Way™

Perspective

Lead with integrity, humility, honesty, and biblical stewardship.

Essence

Demonstrate empathy, respect, and emotional maturity while maintaining professional boundaries.

Nutrition

Provide practical educational guidance that supports informed lifestyle choices without making medical claims.

Case Study

Scenario

A participant asks you whether they should stop taking a medication because they have begun drinking an herbal tea that they believe is working better.

Questions:

1. How should you respond while remaining within your professional scope?
2. What educational information can you provide?
3. When would referral to a licensed healthcare professional be appropriate?
4. How should this interaction be documented?

Reflection

Journal the following:

- Why are ethics essential to professional herbal practice?
- How does professionalism build trust?
- What qualities define a Registered Wellness Herbalist?
- How will you continue learning after completing this diploma?

Module Assignments

Assignment 1

Professional Wellness Binder

Create a complete professional documentation system.

Include:

- Intake form
- Informed consent
- Wellness review form
- Follow-up documentation
- Educational disclaimer
- Progress notes
- Referral form
- Wellness journal template

Assignment 2

Code of Ethics Reflection

Read the NHMEC Code of Ethics.

Write a 2–3 page reflection discussing:

- Professional responsibility
- Integrity
- Confidentiality
- Lifelong learning
- Biblical stewardship

Assignment 3

Professional Policies Manual

Develop a professional handbook for your wellness practice.

Include:

- Mission statement
- Scope of practice

- Educational disclaimer
- Appointment policies
- Confidentiality policy
- Record retention policy
- Continuing education goals
- Professional expectations

Assignment 4

Case Documentation Exercise

Complete documentation for three fictional wellness education sessions.

Include:

- Intake summary
- Wellness observations
- Educational topics discussed
- Lifestyle recommendations
- Follow-up plan
- Appropriate documentation language

Vocabulary

Define the following:

- Ethics
- Scope of Practice
- Informed Consent
- Confidentiality
- Documentation
- Professional Boundaries
- Accountability
- Competence
- Referral
- Continuing Education

Discussion Questions

1. Why is documentation important in professional wellness practice?
2. How does informed consent protect both practitioner and participant?

3. Why must Wellness Herbalists remain within their educational scope?
4. How can professional communication strengthen public confidence?
5. Why is continuing education essential for maintaining registration?

Module Quiz

25 Multiple Choice Questions

Topics include:

- Professional ethics
- Documentation
- Scope of practice
- Informed consent
- Confidentiality
- Professional communication
- Continuing education
- Registration standards

Passing Score: 80%

Students who do not achieve a passing score may review the module and retake the assessment.

Preparing for Module 11

In Module 11, students will integrate everything learned throughout the diploma by designing and delivering comprehensive wellness education programs. Emphasis will be placed on curriculum development, teaching strategies, mentorship, ministry, and preparing for the capstone project that demonstrates readiness for NHMEC Professional Registration.